Inventec (2356.TW): Increasing contribution from AI server putting pressure on margin; Neutral

Inventec reported 3Q26 results on November 10th. 3Q OP was 3/14% below GSe/BBG consensus, while OPM was 1.6% in 3Q26, which was 0.1/0.3ppt lower than our estimates/BBG consensus. GM of 4.2% was lower than our estimates/BBG consensus by 0.2/0.4ppt on change in product mix (servers accounted for 50%+ of total revenue in 3Q26 vs. 46-50% in 2Q26). Total revenue was in line with GSe but 1% higher than consensus.

Going into 4Q26, we expect revenue to reach NT$266,950mn (-2% QoQ, +56% YoY), as we expect the solid YoY will be mainly driven by the server business. We expect GM to remain stable at 4.2% (flattish QoQ and -1.0ppt YoY). We continue to expect the company's revenue to expand on increasing contribution from the server business while GM remains under pressure.

Overall, we maintain our Neutral rating on Inventec with a new 12-m TP of NT$56 (from NT$61).

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Exhibit 1: Inventec 3Q26 result comp table

Inventec (2356.TW)	3Q26			QoQ		YoY		Bloomberg consensus	
P&L (NT$mn)	Actual	GS est.	Diff (%)	2Q26	QoQ	3Q25	YoY	Consensus	%
Revenue	272,094	272,094	0%	269,857	1%	176,286	54%	268,103	1%
Gross profits	11,334	11,873	-5%	11,416	-1%	8,876	28%	12,222	-7%
Operating profits	4,373	4,526	-3%	4,741	-8%	3,067	43%	5,079	-14%
Pre-tax income	3,048	3,791	-20%	5,017	-39%	4,204	-27%	4,398	-31%
Net earnings	2,538	2,995	-15%	3,895	-35%	2,729	-7%	3,435	-26%
EPS, NT$	0.71	0.83	-15%	1.09	-35%	0.76	-7%	0.93	-24%
Gross margin (%)	4.2%	4.4%	-0.2ppt	4.2%	-0.1ppt	5.0%	-0.9ppt	4.6%	-0.4ppt
EBIT margin (%)	1.6%	1.7%	-0.1ppt	1.8%	-0.1ppt	1.7%	-0.1ppt	1.9%	-0.3ppt
Net margin (%)	0.9%	1.1%	-0.2ppt	1.4%	-0.5ppt	1.5%	-0.6ppt	1.3%	-0.3ppt

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Earnings revision

We revise down our 2026 earnings estimates by 8% to factor in 3Q26 results (we revise up our 2026E revenue estimates by 1%). We revise down 2027/28E earnings estimates by 9%/8% to reflect product mix with higher contribution from the server business (we revise up our 2027/28E revenue estimates by 6/6%). We now expect the GM expansion to be slower due to the higher server business contribution that is margin dilutive, thus revise down GPM by 0.2/0.2/0.2ppt in 2026/27/28E.

Exhibit 2: Inventec earnings revision table

Inventec P&L (NT$ mn)	2026E New	2026E Old	Diff.	2027E New	2027E Old	Diff.	2028E New	2028E Old	Diff.
Sales	1,009,211	994,450	1%	1,210,896	1,143,384	6%	1,307,754	1,234,656	6%
Gross Profit	44,256	45,116	-2%	55,357	55,062	1%	63,271	62,553	1%
EBIT	16,531	17,421	-5%	22,057	23,619	-7%	25,477	26,871	-5%
Net Income	11,273	12,313	-8%	13,911	15,267	-9%	17,148	18,566	-8%
EPS (NT$)	**3.14**	**3.43**	-8%	**3.88**	**4.26**	-9%	**4.78**	**5.18**	-8%
Ratio analysis									
Gross margin	4.4%	4.5%	-0.2ppt	4.6%	4.8%	-0.2ppt	4.8%	5.1%	-0.2ppt
EBIT margin	1.6%	1.8%	-0.1ppt	1.8%	2.1%	-0.2ppt	1.9%	2.2%	-0.2ppt
Net margin	1.1%	1.2%	-0.1ppt	1.1%	1.3%	-0.2ppt	1.3%	1.5%	-0.2ppt

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation:

We reiterate our Neutral rating on Inventec with a new 12m TP of NT$56 (from NT$61), based on 14.2x 2027E P/E (unchanged), which is the company's average P/E for the past 10 years, and factoring in our earnings revision.

Exhibit 3: Inventec P&L table

NT$mn	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26E	1Q27E	2Q27E	3Q27E	4Q27E	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	157,034	186,577	176,286	171,293	200,311	269,857	272,094	266,950	253,237	308,184	324,137	325,339	646,262	691,190	1,009,211	1,210,896	1,307,754
Gross profit	9,413	9,503	8,876	8,923	10,177	11,416	11,334	11,329	11,380	13,956	15,005	15,015	33,337	36,715	44,256	55,357	63,271
Operating expense	(2,402)	(2,323)	(2,453)	(2,521)	(2,838)	(2,790)	(2,879)	(3,203)	(3,039)	(3,698)	(3,890)	(3,904)	(8,919)	(9,700)	(11,711)	(14,531)	(17,001)
Operating income	3,473	3,635	3,067	2,538	3,615	4,741	4,373	3,801	4,416	5,481	6,091	6,069	11,817	12,713	16,531	22,057	25,477
Pretax income	2,152	2,912	4,204	2,744	3,307	5,017	3,048	3,053	3,401	4,466	5,076	5,053	9,210	12,012	14,425	17,996	22,183
Taxes expense	(448)	(718)	(892)	(664)	(873)	(1,117)	(482)	(641)	(772)	(1,014)	(1,152)	(1,147)	(1,944)	(2,722)	(3,113)	(4,085)	(5,036)
Net income	1,703	2,190	2,729	2,073	2,428	3,895	2,538	2,412	2,629	3,452	3,923	3,906	7,267	8,696	11,273	13,911	17,148
EPS, NT$	**0.47**	**0.61**	**0.76**	**0.58**	**0.68**	**1.09**	**0.71**	**0.67**	**0.73**	**0.96**	**1.09**	**1.09**	**2.03**	**2.42**	**3.14**	**3.88**	**4.78**
Ratio analysis and assumption																	
As % of sales																	
Gross margin	6.0%	5.1%	5.0%	5.2%	5.1%	4.2%	4.2%	4.2%	4.5%	4.5%	4.6%	4.6%	5.2%	5.3%	4.4%	4.6%	4.8%
Operating expense ratio	1.5%	1.2%	1.4%	1.5%	1.4%	1.0%	1.1%	1.2%	1.2%	1.2%	1.2%	1.2%	1.4%	1.4%	1.2%	1.2%	1.3%
Operating margin	2.2%	1.9%	1.7%	1.5%	1.8%	1.8%	1.6%	1.4%	1.7%	1.8%	1.9%	1.9%	1.8%	1.8%	1.6%	1.8%	1.9%
Net margin	1.1%	1.2%	1.5%	1.2%	1.2%	1.4%	0.9%	0.9%	1.0%	1.1%	1.2%	1.2%	1.1%	1.3%	1.1%	1.1%	1.3%
QoQ growth (%)																	
Revenue	-20.6%	18.8%	-5.5%	-2.8%	16.9%	34.7%	0.8%	-1.9%	-5.1%	21.7%	5.2%	0.4%	-	-	-	-	-
Gross profit	-6.6%	1.0%	-6.6%	0.5%	14.0%	12.2%	-0.7%	0.0%	0.5%	22.6%	7.5%	0.1%	-	-	-	-	-
Operating income	-11.4%	4.7%	-15.6%	-17.2%	42.4%	31.2%	-7.8%	-13.1%	16.2%	24.1%	11.1%	-0.4%	-	-	-	-	-
Net income	-28.1%	28.6%	24.6%	-24.0%	17.1%	60.4%	-34.8%	-5.0%	9.0%	31.3%	13.7%	-0.4%	-	-	-	-	-
YoY growth (%)																	
Revenue	20.3%	21.0%	7.6%	-13.4%	27.6%	44.6%	54.3%	55.8%	26.4%	14.2%	19.1%	21.9%	25.5%	7.0%	46.0%	20.0%	8.0%
Gross profit	36.8%	22.7%	2.8%	-11.4%	8.1%	20.1%	27.7%	27.0%	11.8%	22.2%	32.4%	32.5%	26.6%	10.1%	20.5%	25.1%	14.3%
Operating income	62.5%	39.8%	-3.0%	-35.2%	4.1%	30.4%	42.6%	49.8%	22.2%	15.6%	39.3%	59.7%	58.3%	7.6%	30.0%	33.4%	15.5%
Net income	56.4%	20.9%	36.6%	-12.5%	42.6%	77.9%	-7.0%	16.3%	8.3%	-11.4%	54.6%	62.0%	14.4%	19.7%	29.6%	23.4%	23.3%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Investment thesis and Valuation & Risks

Inventec is an ODM company focusing on the design and manufacturing of PCs, servers, and consumer electronics. While we like Inventec's solid position in the AI server ODM market, we are Neutral rated as we believe valuation already reflects near-term positives. We model Inventec earnings growth in 2026-28E to be driven by the commercial PC demand recovery and AI server ramp-up. We model AI servers to contribute more in 2026-28E. We see P/E valuation as fair at the current level compared to its peers and already reflects the solid growth in 2026-28E. Catalysts for further upside/downside would be its customers' demand on AI servers and general server demand outlook.

Valuation methodology: Our 12m TP of NT$56 is based on 14.2x 2027E P/E, which is the company's average P/E for the past 10 years.

Key upside/downside risks: (1) stronger-/weaker-than-expected PC market recovery; (2) faster-/slower-than-expected AI server ramp-up; and (3) stronger-/weaker-than-expected demand for general servers.

2356.TW	12m Price Target: **NT$56.00**	Price: **NT$51.20**	Upside: **9.4%**

Neutral

Market cap: NT$184.2bn / $5.6bn
Enterprise value: NT$254.7bn / $7.7bn
3m ADTV: NT$1.2bn / $36.4mn
Taiwan
Greater China Electronic Components
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (NT$ mn) New	**691,190.3**	**1,009,211.1**	**1,210,896.4**	**1,307,754.2**
Revenue (NT$ mn) Old	691,190.3	994,449.8	1,143,383.5	1,234,655.9
EBITDA (NT$ mn)	17,216.1	20,733.4	28,520.9	32,599.6
EPS (NT$) New	**2.42**	**3.14**	**3.88**	**4.78**
EPS (NT$) Old	2.42	3.43	4.26	5.18
P/E (X)	18.1	16.3	13.2	10.7
P/B (X)	2.1	2.4	2.3	2.2
Dividend yield (%)	4.5	5.0	6.2	7.7
CROCI (%)	10.6	17.7	22.2	22.9

	9/26	12/26E	3/27E	6/27E
EPS (NT$)	0.71	0.67	0.73	0.96

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 11 Nov 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Chao Wang, Allen Chang and Al Wang, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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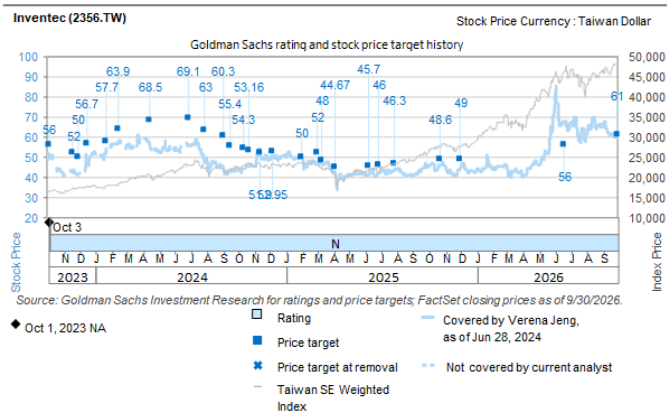
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Target price history table(s)

Inventec (2356.TW)

Date of report	Target price (NT$)	Closing price (NT$)
29-Sep-26	61.00	59.20
19-Jun-26	56.00	67.70
01-Dec-25	49.00	44.05
23-Oct-25	48.60	45.85
28-Jul-25	46.30	43.75
28-Jun-25	46.00	42.50
08-Jun-25	45.70	41.10
06-Apr-25	44.67	42.85
11-Mar-25	48.00	47.80
01-Mar-25	52.00	46.50
31-Jan-25	50.00	-
06-Dec-24	52.95	50.50
13-Nov-24	51.90	51.00
22-Oct-24	53.16	46.00
11-Oct-24	54.30	44.40
17-Sep-24	55.40	43.55
02-Sep-24	60.30	45.45
29-Jul-24	63.00	47.00
28-Jun-24	69.10	55.80
15-Apr-24	68.50	56.00
14-Feb-24	63.90	-
23-Jan-24	57.70	57.20
15-Dec-23	56.70	48.40
29-Nov-23	50.00	41.60
19-Nov-23	52.00	42.65

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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